

A GUIDE FOR CONSULTANTS AND COACHES

THE \$10K MESSAGE

How I Closed \$10,000 in LinkedIn Clients in 5 Days
Using One Simple Framework

Plus 25 DM Scripts That Actually Work

BLOSSOM AFFIA

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Nigeria's No. 1 LinkedIn Growth Creator · Founder, The LinkedIn Creator's Lab

***“GOD HAD NOT HIDDEN THE OPPORTUNITY.
I HAD JUST BEEN LOOKING TOO BROADLY TO SEE IT.”***

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Rewritten using real outbound principles. Ready to use today.

CHAPTER ONE

THE MORNING EVERYTHING FELT OFF

The tea hit the floor before I even had time to catch it.

It was 7:43 in the morning. My dog was standing in the doorway looking at me like I had personally offended her. My laptop was open on the table, notifications piling up, calendar full of things that felt important but were not moving anything forward.

I had been doing this for months. Not lazily. I was serious about it. I showed up on LinkedIn every single day. I wrote posts that people genuinely engaged with. I commented on other people's content. I replied to everyone. I did what the smart people said to do.

And it was working. A little.

People followed me. They commented. They said things like "this is so valuable" and "you always know what to say." A few people called me their favourite creator on the platform.

But nobody was paying me.

THERE IS A DIFFERENCE BETWEEN BEING LIKED AND BEING HIRED.

I knew it intellectually. But I had not truly felt it until that morning, sitting in a wet shirt, looking at a calendar full of free conversations and zero invoices.

I had built an audience. What I had not built was a business.

That evening, I did something different. I did not post. I did not comment. I did not work on my content strategy. I opened my LinkedIn DMs and wrote one message to someone I had been watching for a few weeks. It was short. It named something specific I had noticed in their business. And it ended with one easy question.

I sent it and closed the laptop.

Two hours later, I had a reply. The next morning, I had a discovery call booked. Three days after that, I had a signed retainer. By day five, I had closed \$10,000.

I sat there and thought: I have been posting every day for months. The money came from one direct message.

I was not confused about why it worked. I was confused about why I had waited so long to try it.

***GOD HAD NOT HIDDEN THE OPPORTUNITY. I HAD JUST BEEN
LOOKING TOO BROADLY TO SEE IT.***

The platform had never been the problem. My approach to it was. This book is about what I changed, why it worked, and exactly how you can do the same. But before we get to the method, you need to understand the mistake. Because I had been making it for months and I did not even know it had a name.

CHAPTER TWO

THE LIE NOBODY TALKS ABOUT

Here is the thing nobody tells you about building an audience.

Attention is not trust. And trust is not money.

You can have thirty thousand followers and an empty pipeline. You can be called a thought leader on Tuesday and have no new clients by Friday. You can post every day for a year and still feel like nothing is moving.

That is not a content problem. It is a message problem.

When someone likes your post, they are saying one thing: this was worth 30 seconds of my time. That is all. It does not mean they trust you. It does not mean they will hire you. It does not mean they will reply when you reach out.

I know this because I had thousands of followers. My engagement was real. People tagged their friends in my posts. And when I messaged someone about working together, I got silence. Or a polite “thanks but not right now.”

The problem was not them. It was me.

I was writing DMs that sounded like mini-posts. Big ideas, broad insights, vague value propositions. I was talking about what I do instead of what they need. I was sending messages that could have been sent to anyone, and they read exactly like that.

STOP TRYING TO SOUND IMPRESSIVE. START TRYING TO BE SPECIFIC.

David Ogilvy said it decades ago: if you want someone to respond, you cannot speak in your own vocabulary. You have to speak in theirs. You have to describe their problem in language so familiar that they feel like you wrote it for them personally.

Seth Godin says trust has to be earned. Not through volume. Not through consistency. Through recognition. The feeling that this person actually understands my situation.

The first message you send a potential client is not just an opener. It is a test. A test of whether you understand their world. If you pass, the conversation begins. If you fail, they move on and you never know why.

Most people are failing that test and blaming the platform.

The platform is fine. The message is the problem. And before you can fix the message, you need to understand what is actually happening on the other side of the inbox when your message arrives.

CHAPTER THREE

WHY YOUR MESSAGES ARE BEING IGNORED

Put yourself on the other side of the inbox for a moment.

You are a busy consultant. You have a client meeting in 40 minutes, two proposals to review, and a message you have been avoiding since Monday. Then a LinkedIn notification appears. You open the DM. It says:

"Hi [Name]! I came across your profile and I love what you are doing. I am a [job title] who helps [broad audience] with [vague outcome]. Would love to connect and see if there is any synergy."

You do not reply. You close the app.

Not because you are rude. Because that message cost the sender five seconds and it shows. There is nothing in it that was written for you specifically. No reason to respond. No real observation. No useful next step. Just noise shaped like outreach.

Sales trainer Josh Braun calls this "commission breath." It is the scent of someone who wants something from you before they have given you anything. Prospects feel it immediately. And the moment they feel it, they switch off.

The frustrating part is that most people sending these messages are genuinely good at what they do. They have real skills. They have helped real people. They just have not learned that the inbox is not the place to tell your story. It is the place to show that you understand someone else's.

There are three things that kill a DM before it has a chance.

THE GENERIC OPENER

“I love your profile” means nothing. It proves nothing. It tells the other person you could have sent this to anyone with a LinkedIn account and a pulse.

THE FEATURES-FIRST PITCH

“I help companies with X, Y, and Z” is not a reason to reply. It is a reason to move on. Nobody reads their inbox looking for a services menu.

THE HEAVY ASK

“Would you be open to a 30-minute call?” in a first cold message is too much. You have not earned that yet. You have not given them a single reason to give you half an hour of their life.

THE GOAL OF THE FIRST MESSAGE IS ONE REPLY. NOT A SALE.

What works is the opposite of all three. A specific observation that proves you actually looked at their world. A reframe that helps them see something differently. And one small, frictionless ask that costs them almost nothing to say yes to. That is the whole thing. And there is a framework that puts it together in a way that is simple enough to use every day. It is called SEE-LOCK. But first, let me show you the message that proved it works.

CHAPTER FOUR

THE SHIFT THAT CHANGED EVERYTHING

Let me tell you exactly what I sent that evening.

The person was a business consultant. She had been posting regularly about growing her practice. The content was good. But something in one of her recent posts caught my attention. She mentioned she had been “focused on thought leadership lately.” To me, that read like someone who had quietly stopped doing direct outreach and was hoping content would fill the gap.

I wrote this:

Noticed you have been going deep on thought leadership lately. A lot of consultants do that when pipeline gets quiet, hoping content will do the work that outreach used to do. I have seen one switch that reverses it fast. Want me to share it?

That was the whole message. Twenty-three words of observation. One question.

She replied within two hours. We got on a call the next day. I shared what I knew. She signed a retainer three days later. By day five, I had closed \$10,000.

Why that message worked.

The first line named something specific. Not her name or her job title. Something she had actually said and done recently. That proved I was paying attention. Not to LinkedIn in general. To her specifically.

The second line reframed her behaviour. I connected what she was doing to a pattern I had seen in other consultants. Not to criticise her. To show her she was not alone, and that the pattern had a name and a fix.

The third line made one simple, easy ask. Not “let us jump on a call.” Not “check out my services.” Just: want me to share one thing? A yes or no question with zero weight attached.

I had been overcomplicating everything for months when the answer was this clean.

SOMETIMES THE BLESSING IS NOT BIGGER EFFORT. IT IS BETTER SIGHT.

I do believe God had a hand in the timing. I was ready to see it when it happened. Once I saw it clearly, I could not unsee it. That framework has a name now. I call it SEE-LOCK. And the next chapter is going to break it down completely so you can use it today.

CHAPTER FIVE

THE SEE-LOCK FRAMEWORK

SEE-LOCK is not a script. It is a way of thinking before you type anything.

It does not tell you what to say. It tells you how to think so that when you do say something, it lands. The three parts are SEE, LOCK, and OFFER. Each one does a specific job.

SEE

Notice something real about this specific person. Not a compliment. Not “great post.” A signal. A pattern. A detail that most people would scroll past.

A founder posts about hiring their third salesperson in two months. That is a growth signal. Budget exists. Problems are multiplying faster than processes. A marketing director writes honestly about why their last campaign underperformed. That is a vulnerability signal. They are open to new approaches.

LOCK

Take what you noticed and frame it in a way that creates a moment of reflection. Shine a light on a cost they have not calculated, a gap they have normalised, or a pattern they have not named yet.

Josh Braun calls this “poking the bear.” The best LOCKs feel like relief. Like someone finally put words to something they had been sensing but could not articulate.

OFFER

Give them the smallest possible next step. One question. One idea. Something useful that costs them almost nothing to say yes to. Not a call. Not a proposal. Just one easy move. The OFFER must feel weightless.

Putting it all together.

Here is what a full SEE-LOCK message looks like for a consultant whose recent posts suggest they are struggling with pricing:

Saw your comment on the pricing post this week. Most consultants at your stage have the same challenge — the work is excellent but the positioning does not match the rate you want to charge. I have one reframe that tends to shift this. Want me to share it?

Three sentences. One reply. That is all you need to start a conversation that can become a client.

THE FRAMEWORK IS THE THINKING. EVEN BEFORE YOU WRITE THE MESSAGE, YOU NEED TO KNOW WHO TO WRITE IT TO.

That is what the next chapter is about.

CHAPTER SIX

HOW TO FIND THE RIGHT PERSON TO MESSAGE

Not everyone on LinkedIn is ready to hear from you right now.

Most people are fine. They are not in pain. They are not in growth mode. They are not thinking about hiring someone like you this week. And if you message them anyway, the best you can hope for is a polite non-reply.

But some people are ready. And here is the thing: they are telling you, publicly, if you know what to look for.

Morgan Ingram, one of the sharpest outbound coaches working today, teaches this as a core principle: layer your public observation with your private outreach. Engage with their content first. Leave a real comment. By the time your DM arrives, you are not a cold stranger. You are someone they have already noticed.

The five signals to watch for.

THE GROWTH SIGNAL

A new hire announcement. A new product launch. A new market. They are building, which means budget exists and new problems are forming faster than solutions. That gap is where you live.

THE PAIN SIGNAL

An honest post about what is not working. A question that reveals a gap. Someone asking their network for recommendations. People who can name their own pain are already halfway to buying a solution.

THE TRANSITION SIGNAL

A new role. A new title. A new company. They are in proving mode. They want results fast. They are more open to outside help in the first 90 days than at any other time.

THE ENGAGEMENT SIGNAL

A thoughtful comment on a post directly related to your area. Not a like. A real sentence. That tells you exactly what is on their mind right now and gives you the perfect opener.

THE QUIET SIGNAL

Someone who used to post consistently and has gone silent. This often means they are deep in execution, overwhelmed, or stuck. All three are reasons to reach out with something useful.

VOLUME IS FOR PEOPLE WHO HAVE NOT FIGURED OUT TARGETING YET.

Once you start reading these signals, your outreach list changes completely. You are not messaging everyone who fits a job title. You are messaging the five or six people this week who gave you a specific, concrete reason to reach out. Once you know who to message, the message almost writes itself. The next chapter shows you how.

CHAPTER SEVEN

HOW TO WRITE THE FIRST MESSAGE

Most first messages die in the first sentence.

Research by LinkedIn shows that most users decide whether to reply within seconds of opening a DM. If the first sentence is generic, the decision is made before they reach the second. So the opener is not just the beginning. It is the whole game.

Line one: Start with what you saw, not who you are.

Do not open with your job title. Do not tell them you came across their profile. Start with something you actually noticed about them.

NOT THIS

"I came across your profile and love what you are building."

THIS

"Saw your post about the Q1 pipeline gap. You attributed it to messaging, not market conditions."

Line two: The LOCK. One insight, not a pitch.

This is where your expertise shows up. Not in a list of credentials. In one observation that makes them think differently about their situation. Keep it to one sentence. Anything longer starts to feel like a lecture.

Line three: The OFFER. One small ask.

A yes or no question. Something useful with no strings attached. Justin Welsh says it clearly: the first message is not supposed to sell. It is supposed to get a reply. Keep the message focused on earning that reply.

The full message: four to six sentences maximum.

Saw your comment about the pricing challenge on [post]. Most consultants at your stage hit the same wall — the work is strong but the positioning makes it hard to charge what it is worth. I have a reframe that tends to unlock this quickly. Want me to share it?

One more thing. Before you send, read the message out loud. If it sounds like a corporate email, rewrite it. It should sound like something a real person would say to another real person over a quick coffee. If you would not say it out loud, do not send it in writing.

A STRONG MESSAGE DOES NOT NEED TO BE LONG. IT NEEDS TO FEEL TRUE.

The reply comes. Now the real conversation begins. And that is where most people freeze, because they did not plan for what happens next.

CHAPTER EIGHT

WHAT HAPPENS AFTER THE FIRST REPLY

The reply comes in. And most people freeze.

They either say too much, pouring out everything they have ever wanted to share. Or they say too little, missing the moment completely. Both mistakes come from the same problem: not knowing what each stage of the conversation is actually for.

Every stage has exactly one job. Do that job, then move to the next. Do not skip ahead.

STAGE 1 — AFTER THE FIRST REPLY

Job: keep the conversation going. Ask one question. Make them talk more.

“That’s really useful to know. What have you already tried to fix this?”

STAGE 2 — MOVING TO A CALL

Job: get 15 minutes on the calendar with a specific purpose.

“There’s enough here to map out properly. I have 15 minutes Thursday at 2pm or Friday morning. Either work?”

STAGE 3 — THE DISCOVERY CALL

Job: understand the problem deeply enough to describe it back to them better than they described it to you. Listen more than you talk. That moment of recognition is when trust locks in.

STAGE 4 — THE PROPOSAL

Job: send it within 24 hours while the call is still fresh. Keep it simple: problem, solution, price, next step. Three pages maximum. The proposal should feel like a summary of the conversation, not a formal sales document.

STAGE 5 — THE FOLLOW-UP

Job: follow up once with value and once with a close-the-loop message. Not five times. The appendix has the exact scripts for each moment in this stage.

THE WHOLE ARC, FROM FIRST REPLY TO SIGNED RETAINER, DOES NOT HAVE TO TAKE WEEKS.

It took five days for me. It can take you less. The key is knowing what each moment is for, and not trying to do everything in one go. Structure without repetition is just theory. The last chapter is about turning this into something you actually do every day.

CHAPTER NINE

THE DAILY PRACTICE

Everything in this book means nothing if it only happens once.

The people who close clients consistently on LinkedIn are not doing it with one lucky message or one viral post. They are working a practice. A small, deliberate routine that runs before anything else starts in the morning.

Morgan Ingram coaches B2B sales teams and the first thing he changes is how they spend their first hour. He moves them away from volume and towards observation. Justin Welsh built a business that generates millions, and he combined content with direct, intentional outreach from the very beginning.

Here is what twenty minutes a morning looks like when it is done well.

MINUTES 1 TO 5 — SHOW UP FIRST

Reply to every comment and DM you received. Not with a like. With a sentence. Build your presence before you ask anything of the platform.

MINUTES 6 TO 15 — OBSERVE

Scroll your feed like a detective. Look for the five signals from Chapter 6. Write down two or three names of people who gave you a reason to reach out this week. You are not messaging yet. You are building your list.

MINUTES 16 TO 20 — SEND

Write and send one to three messages using SEE-LOCK. Not mass outreach. Specific, personal messages to people who gave you a signal. Short, direct, and human.

That is twenty minutes. That is the whole practice.

The results are not immediate. The first week might bring one reply. By the fourth week, done consistently with real targeting, you will have multiple conversations in motion. By the end of the second month, you will have a system that generates leads without you having to chase anyone.

YOU DO NOT NEED TO MESSAGE A HUNDRED PEOPLE. YOU NEED TO MESSAGE TEN PEOPLE WHO GAVE YOU A SPECIFIC REASON TO REACH OUT.

Do that for thirty days. See what opens.

I do believe the right opportunities find the right people when they are ready to receive them. This practice is how you stay ready. The 25 scripts in the appendix are what you use while you are doing it.

APPENDIX

25 LINKEDIN DM SCRIPTS THAT HAVE CLOSED REAL CLIENTS

These are not templates you fill in and fire off. They are starting points you understand well enough to make yours.

Each script is followed by a short note on what makes it work. Read the note. That is where the real value is.

SECTION 1

Cold Outreach

Scripts 01–10. For strangers who do not know you yet.

SECTION 2

Warm Follow-Up

Scripts 06–10. For people who already know your name.

SECTION 3

Discovery Call Invite

Scripts 11–15. Moving the conversation to a call.

SECTIONS 4–5

Proposal Close + Retainer

Scripts 16–25. Closing deals and securing retainers.

COLD OUTREACH

SCRIPT 01

The SEE-LOCK Opener

Use when you have noticed something specific about their business that most people would miss.

Saw your post about [specific topic]. You mentioned [specific detail] — most people skip right past that. I work with people who already get that part. The gap is usually [where you can help]. Want me to share one thing that tends to unlock it?

What makes it work: You are demonstrating that you actually read their content and thought about it. That alone separates you from 95% of cold messages.

SCRIPT 02

The Mutual Ground Opener

Use when you share a connection, community, or event.

Hi [Name], [mutual person/community/event] connected us. I have been watching what you are doing with [topic] — good stuff. I have been helping people in similar spots with [specific thing]. Might be worth a quick chat. Are you open to it?

What makes it work: The mutual ground lowers the psychological barrier. You are not a stranger — you are an acquaintance once removed.

SCRIPT 03

The Problem-First Opener

Use when you can name a specific pain point their business is likely facing.

Hi [Name], most [type of business] I speak to are dealing with [specific problem]. It is not obvious and it is not their fault — it usually comes from [root cause]. I have helped [specific type of client] solve exactly this. Worth a quick conversation to see if it is relevant to you?

What makes it work: You are naming the pain before they have to. That builds instant credibility. You understand their world without them having to explain it.

SCRIPT 04

The Results-Led Opener

Use when you have a strong result you can reference immediately.

Hi [Name], I just helped [type of client] get [specific result] in [timeframe]. Your situation looks similar. I have one thing that made the difference for them — happy to share it. Want me to?

What makes it work: The result is the hook. Everything else just creates space for the conversation. Keep the result specific — vague claims are ignored.

SCRIPT 05

The Direct Ask Opener

Use when you have done enough research to go straight to the point.

Hi [Name], I looked at what you are building and I think I can help with [specific thing]. I have done this with [type of client] before — [brief result]. Twenty minutes this week. Worth it?

What makes it work: Some decision-makers respect directness above everything. This message respects their time and signals that you know what you are doing.

WARM FOLLOW-UP

SCRIPT 06

The Re-Engagement Message

Use when you connected before but the conversation went cold.

Hi [Name], it has been a while since we last spoke. I have been following your work and saw [specific recent update]. A lot has changed on my end too — I have since [relevant progress]. I think the timing might be better now. Would you be open to picking up where we left off?

What makes it work: You show you have been paying attention. You signal progress. And you make it easy for them to say yes by framing it as a continuation, not a cold start.

SCRIPT 07

The Congratulations Bridge

Use when they have hit a milestone, launch, or public win recently.

Hi [Name], I saw [specific milestone or launch]. The way you handled [specific detail] stood out — most people skip that part. I work with people at this exact stage on [next level outcome]. Twenty minutes to talk through what that could look like for you?

What makes it work: A genuine compliment followed by a forward-looking question. You are not celebrating their past — you are pointing at their future and offering to be part of it.

SCRIPT 08

The Content Reaction Follow-Up

Use after they have engaged with your content or liked one of your posts.

Hi [Name], you reacted to my post on [topic]. Given what you do at [company], that probably landed close to home. I have seen this play out a lot with people in your position — want me to share how they handled it?

What makes it work: They have already shown interest. You are simply extending the conversation they started by engaging with your content. This is a warm door — walk through it.

SCRIPT 09

The Referral Warm-Up

Use when someone they trust has mentioned you or recommended you reach out.

Hi [Name], [mutual contact] said I should reach out. They thought what I do would be useful for what you are working on. Happy to share a bit more if you are curious — just say the word.

What makes it work: You lead with the referral immediately. That name is your credibility transfer. Do not bury it — it is the most powerful part of the message.

SCRIPT 10

The Value-First Follow-Up

Use when you want to offer something genuinely useful before asking for anything.

Hi [Name], I put together a short breakdown on [relevant topic] that I think could be useful for what you are building at [company]. No pitch, no ask — just something I thought was worth sharing. Want me to send it over?

What makes it work: You are leading with generosity. A yes to receiving something free is easy. And once they have your value, the conversation has already started.

DISCOVERY CALL INVITE

SCRIPT 11

The Specificity Invite

Use when you have had some dialogue and want to move to a call.

Based on what you have shared, I think I can specifically help with [specific problem they mentioned]. I do not want to try to solve it in a message thread. A 20-minute call would be far more useful for you. Are you free [specific day] or [specific day]?

What makes it work: You are referencing what they have already told you. You are showing that you listened. And you give two specific options — this removes decision fatigue.

SCRIPT 12

The Low-Pressure Invite

Use when you sense they are interested but slightly hesitant.

I am not looking to pitch you anything on a call. I genuinely want to understand what you are working on and share a few thoughts that might be useful. If something fits, great. If not, you walk away with a fresh perspective on [topic].
Twenty minutes. No pressure.

What makes it work: You are removing the fear of being sold to. Most people avoid calls because they expect a pitch. Remove that expectation and you remove the resistance.

SCRIPT 13

The Social Proof Invite

Use when you have a strong result that is directly relevant to them.

I recently worked with [similar company type] and helped them [specific result] in [timeframe]. Before that they were dealing with [specific problem you suspect they also have]. I would like to walk you through what we did — not to copy it but to see if the same thinking applies to your situation. Can we get 20 minutes on the calendar?

What makes it work: The result is the bait. The walkthrough framing removes the sales pressure. And the last question is direct and easy to say yes to.

SCRIPT 14

The Timely Trigger Invite

Use when you have noticed a trigger event — new role, new product, funding, expansion.

Hi [Name], saw the [trigger event — funding / new role / launch]. Congrats. That stage tends to bring [specific challenge] up fast. I have helped a few people get through it cleanly. Got 20 minutes this week to talk through it?

What makes it work: You are showing up at the right moment with the right message. Timing is everything in outreach. Trigger events are the windows — learn to spot them.

SCRIPT 15

The Pre-Call Confirmation

Use to confirm a scheduled call and set the tone before it starts.

Looking forward to our call on [date/time]. To make the most of our time, I will come prepared with [specific thing you plan to bring — audit, ideas, breakdown]. If anything specific has come up that you would like to cover, feel free to drop it here beforehand. See you then.

What makes it work: You are showing professionalism before the call even happens. You signal preparation. And you invite them to come with something specific — which means they will be more engaged when you speak.

PROPOSAL CLOSE

SCRIPT 16

The Post-Call Follow-Up

Use within 24 hours after a discovery call where the conversation went well.

Great conversation earlier. I have been thinking about what you said about [specific thing they mentioned]. Based on that, I believe the best approach for you would be [brief summary of your thinking]. I will have a full proposal to you by [specific date]. Is there anything else I should factor in before I put it together?

What makes it work: You reference what they actually said. You preview the proposal without asking for permission to send it. And you invite one more input — which gives them ownership of what comes next.

SCRIPT 17

The Proposal Send Message

Use when you are sending your proposal or scope of work.

As promised, here is the proposal. I have structured it around [core objective from their conversation]. The approach I am recommending is based on [brief reasoning]. Take your time with it and let me know if anything needs adjusting. Happy to jump on a quick call if it is easier to talk through any section.

What makes it work: You are not just dropping a document — you are framing it. You connect it back to their words. You make revision feel safe. And you keep the relationship warm by offering to talk it through.

SCRIPT 18

The Soft Close

Use a few days after the proposal when you have not heard back.

Just checking in on the proposal I sent over on [date]. I know things get busy. I am still very interested in working together and happy to adjust anything that does not feel right. What are your thoughts so far?

What makes it work: Short. Human. Not pushy. The offer to adjust shows flexibility. The open question is easy to answer — even a "not yet" is a response you can work with.

SCRIPT 19

The Objection Handler

Use when they have raised a concern about budget, timing, or fit.

That makes sense — [their specific concern] is a real thing. Here is how I see it: [your reframe]. For your situation specifically, [your reasoning]. What would need to change for this to feel like the right move?

What makes it work: You validate before you push back. That disarms defensiveness. Then you reframe the concern rather than dismissing it. And the final question moves the conversation forward without forcing a yes.

SCRIPT 20

The Decision Nudge

Use when a deal has been in progress for a while with no decision.

We have been going back and forth for a bit and I feel like we are close. I have a client spot opening up in [timeframe] and I want it to be you. What is still holding this up?

What makes it work: Honest and direct without being aggressive. The scarcity is real — not manufactured. And the last question is designed to surface the final objection so you can address it.

RETAINER NEGOTIATION

SCRIPT 21

The Retainer Introduction

Use after delivering strong results on a project engagement.

The results from [project] are holding up well. I do not want us to lose that momentum. Rather than start fresh each time, I want to propose we keep going on a monthly basis. Can I put together some options for you to look at?

What makes it work: You are framing the retainer as the logical next step, not an upsell. The risk of stopping feels greater than the cost of continuing. That is the psychology you want to activate.

SCRIPT 22

The Long-Term Value Frame

Use when pitching an ongoing relationship rather than a one-off project.

The best work I do with clients happens around month three — when I already know how you think and we stop spending time on context. You also get priority access, consistent output, and a lower cost per piece than one-off projects. Want me to send you a simple breakdown of how that would work?

What makes it work: You explain the value of continuity in concrete terms. The benefits are real and practical. And the question at the end is soft enough that even a cautious client can say yes without committing.

SCRIPT 23

The Renewal Message

Use two to three weeks before a retainer or contract period ends.

We are coming up on the end of [current period]. Before we get there, I want to check in: how are you feeling about the work so far? I want to make sure we are getting you the value you need before we talk about what comes next. Let me know and we can set up a quick call to review and plan the next phase.

What makes it work: You lead with care, not renewal. Asking how they feel about the work is smart — it surfaces any issues before they become reasons to not renew. Address them first, then renew.

SCRIPT 24

The Rate Increase Framing

Use when raising your rate on renewal with a long-term client.

My rate is going up to [new rate] from [date]. This reflects [growth in your skills / scope / demand / results delivered]. I wanted to give you enough notice to plan. Happy to talk through what that looks like going forward if it helps.

What makes it work: Confidence without arrogance. You explain the reason, give advance notice, and anchor it in the relationship. Most clients respect this. The ones who leave were not the right fit.

SCRIPT 25

The Testimonial Request

Use after delivering strong results that a client has acknowledged.

I am really glad [specific result] came together the way it did. I would love to capture your experience in a short testimonial — even just two or three sentences about what you were dealing with before we worked together and what changed. It does not need to be polished. I can help shape it from your words if that is easier.

What makes it work: The offer to shape it from their words removes the main friction. Most clients want to help but do not know how to write a testimonial. Make it easy and you will almost always get one.

BONUS: FOLLOW-UP SCRIPTS

FOLLOW-UP 01

The 48-Hour Check-In

Hi [Name], following up on my message from [day]. I know things pile up. If now is not the right time, just say so and I will come back in [specific later time].

FOLLOW-UP 02

The Value Add Follow-Up

Hi [Name], I came across [relevant article, insight, or resource] and thought of you immediately. It is directly relevant to [challenge they mentioned]. Worth a read. And when you are ready, I would still love to continue our conversation.

FOLLOW-UP 03

The Honest Break Message

Use after multiple messages with no response.

Hi [Name], I have reached out a few times and I imagine if you were interested you would have responded by now. I am going to stop following up after this — I do not want to be a nuisance. If the timing changes and you want to revisit, I am easy to find. Wishing you well with [their project or business].

What makes it work: The break message often gets more replies than the previous three combined. It creates finality — and people often respond to that when they ignored everything else.

FOLLOW-UP 04

The New Angle Follow-Up

Use when you want to try a completely different angle after no response.

Hi [Name], different question this time. What is the one thing about [their business area] taking up the most of your energy right now? I might be able to help. Either way, I am curious.

What makes it work: Pure curiosity with no agenda stated. This is disarming because it asks rather than tells. If they answer, the conversation has started on their terms — which is the best possible foundation.

FOLLOW-UP 05

The Long-Game Check-In

Use three to six months after a conversation that did not convert.

Hi [Name], it has been a few months. I saw [specific progress or development] — looks like things have moved. I am still working with people on [what you do]. Timing might be better now. Worth a quick chat?

A FINAL WORD

THE SCRIPTS DO NOT WORK UNLESS YOU DO.

Every script in this appendix is a starting point. What makes it work is the specificity you bring to it. The real name. The real company. The real thing you noticed. The real problem you can solve.

Generic gets ignored. Specific gets responses. That gap is entirely within your control.

The only thing left is to send the message.

THREE THINGS TO DO BEFORE YOU CLOSE THIS BOOK

- Pick one person in your network right now. Not tomorrow. One person whose name you already know. Open the chat and use Script 01 or Script 04. Just one message. That is the only task.
- Save the scripts you will actually use. You do not need all 25. Pick five that match where you are right now and practise them until they sound like you, not like a template.
- Track your replies, not your sends. The number of messages you send is not the metric. The number of conversations you start is. One reply is worth ten ignored messages.

A NOTE ON REJECTION

Most people who do not reply are not ignoring you. They are busy, distracted, or not ready. The ones who are ready will respond. Your job is to be in front of enough people that when the timing aligns, you are already there. Volume matters. Consistency matters more.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

BLOSSOM AFFIA

#1 LinkedIn Growth Creator in the World — Favikon

I was not supposed to be here.

I posted on LinkedIn for the first time in December 2024. Two people saw it. One of them was probably my best girl. I kept going because where I come from, we don't give up.

Eighteen months later, Favikon ranked me the **#1 LinkedIn growth creator in the world**. Not Nigeria. Not Africa. The world. **I've built a following of 100,000+ stars, clients in Lagos, London, New York, Toronto and beyond**, and a community of people who found their voice after finding mine.

Today, as the Founder of Credence, I help founders and experts close the same gap. You are good at what you do, but if the market doesn't know it yet, you look like everyone else. We build the systems that make the right people see you as the only real choice, and turn your online presence into a revenue-generating asset.

Trusted by ForbesBLK, UBA, Numeris Media, Coachli, Enski, Favikon, CognixAI, Stellar Eminence, StySwap AI, and Africa & Everywhere.

I have trained 1500+ students, coaches and professionals on the secrets of sustainable LinkedIn growth. The distance between 2 impressions and #1 in the world is not talent. It is not luck. It is a system.

If you have read this far, some part of you already knows it is your turn. Welcome to the Fastlane.

WANT MORE FROM ME?

SCALE WITH MY SERVICES

GROWTH WITH CREDENCE

SHOP MY PRODUCTS

RESOURCES & PROGRAMMES

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